

Automotive Electronics Industry Looks Good

In this story, we discuss the scope and opportunities in the field of automotive electronics, entry-level roles for freshers and skills expected of them. We also bring to you some suggestions from industry experts

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The last decade has shown that the electronics in automobiles have multiplied at an astonishing rate. Electronics pretty much influence all functionalities in a vehicle. Some of the reasons driving this trend are—precision, timing, efficiency, standards, safety, comfort, user experience and connectivity. Also, this is in-line with the insatiable desire for gadgetry amongst consumers.

"This trend will definitely continue, perhaps at a much accelerated pace. Automotive semiconductor sales will boom to \$40 billion by 2014. It is estimated that close to 80 per cent of the innovation in automobiles will be in electronics," says Basavaraj Garadi, chief expert, Robert Bosch Engineering and Business Solutions.

Therefore there is no denial of the fact that the future of automotive technology lies in the hands of electronics, thus offering significant scope for professionals to grow and thrive in the automotive electronics industry.

Scope and opportunities

There are scores of Tier-1 and Tier-2 companies actively contributing to the booming electronics in the automotive industry. There are companies engaged in engineering activities, developing new electronic functions in the vehicles and there are also companies producing electronic control units (ECUs), which realise these functions in the vehicles. In addition to these companies are the ever-growing automobile manufacturers. Garadi adds that, "As per the current figures,



A view of Bosch Automotive Electronics India factory

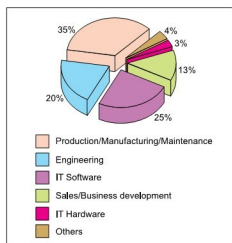


Fig. 1: Share of top five functional areas hiring automotive electronics professionals (Data courtesy: TimesJobs.com)

SIAM—the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers, has 46 members who are the leading vehicle and vehicular engine manufacturers. All of these provide ample opportunities for employment to the fresh graduates passing out of universities."

Today's car is an extension of the smartphone with facilities such as Bluetooth integration, multimedia playback and routing, which opens up interesting career avenues in the in-

dustry. Garadi shares, "In fact we have been seeing frequent advertisements of car manufacturers showcasing the new electronics infotainment features at major events such as CES '14 in Las Vegas."

"There are huge opportunities in the automotive industry as it is leveraging the recent updates in the consumer electronics industry. We are currently witnessing a lot of consolidated CE technologies being moved into automobiles," informs Ravindra B.S., lead architect, Mistral Solutions.

Entry-level roles and training

For fresher engineering graduates, there are opportunities of working on car telematics, electronic car control and car communication with the outside world. With respect to the entry-level roles at Mistral Solutions, Ravindra says, "Entry roles can include maintenance, verification and validation of hardware/software developed using standard life-cycle models."

"Robert Bosch Engineering and Business Solutions Limited (RBEI) re-